

About.me

A new startup, <http://About.Me> by American Online aims to bring all your online content under one URL

Windows 8 tablet at CES2011

Rumours have it that Steve Ballmer will showcase a Windows 8 tablet device at CES 2011

Web Watch

CityVille now bigger than FarmVille

Apparently the biggest Facebook buzz at the end of December was that CityVille was an even bigger runaway success for Zynga than FarmVille. According to numbers released by appdata.com, CityVille had a massive userbase of over 61 million users. Poor old FarmVille was already lagging behind with a mere 56+ million user base – animals are only cute for so long.

What exactly these millions of users see in Zynga's games, in all honesty, is still a mystery to us, but they seem to have the pulse of the Facebook user, that's for sure.

We're wondering how many man hours a month are wasted on these games, since a lot of people are probably playing this in their offices.

A quick survey of our own office revealed that about 15 people had played CityVille or FarmVille at some point in the last month, and claimed to be very addicted to such games. Interestingly, all of them were below the age of 24, and all of them only played the game when in office. We calculated that each of them lost about 30 man hours to the games per month. If we assume that to be average, that's 61 million x 30 = 1.8 billion (yes, billion) man hours being wasted per month! **d**

Mozilla wants to protect your privacy

Aza Raskin, UI designer for Mozilla, said in a blog post on his site, azarask.in that he'd like to see sites start using icons to symbolize what they do with your data. For example, do they give your data to advertisers, or use your data in a way not apparent to you, etc. There are also icons to denote how long the data is kept – under a month, indefinitely, etc.

The idea here is to get sites to start displaying these icons in a way that will bring transparency to the web. It's a noble effort, but one thing's not clear at all to us...

How on earth is anyone ever going to get sites to adopt this? The sites that never share your data with anyone else might be the ones most eager to do so, but what about the rest? With the majority of sites these days sharing your data with advertisers, in order to get some revenues, by showcasing the types of visitors they have, who in their right mind would make a business decision to specifically remind their users that their data is shared with advertisers, or that it's kept indefinitely?

This is another case of a noble thought that just wasn't thought through to completion, or else, just a little naive. **d**

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